

Village Voice — Getting Started Guide

Version 4 · Whiteley Village · May 2026



Welcome to Village Voice

Your digital companion for life at Whiteley Village. Everything you need — in one place, on your phone.

No download

No password to remember

Works on any phone



What is Village Voice?

The platform and what it does

Village Voice is a community platform built specifically for Whiteley Village. It replaces paper notices, phone calls to the office, and the uncertainty of "did I miss anything?" with a simple, always-up-to-date view of everything happening in your community.

WHAT IT GIVES YOU

- Village news and notices — as soon as they're published
- The full events calendar, with one-tap calendar add
- A message board to share thoughts and questions with the community — every post is checked before it appears
- Community surveys — have your say anonymously
- Community contacts and emergency numbers — always one tap away
- The Resident Handbook in a searchable, tappable format
- VoiceMemories — record your story and listen to your neighbours
- A personal space: profile, diary, medications, radio, daily fun



This is a trial. Village Voice is currently available to a small group of Whiteley residents. Your feedback directly shapes what gets built next.



Getting in

Your personal access link

YOUR ACCESS LINK

Village Voice is invitation-only. You were sent a personal link by email. That link is yours — it opens the platform and signs you in automatically. There is no username or password to remember.

Important: Keep your email with the link safe. If you lose it, contact the administrator to have a new link sent.

OPENING FOR THE FIRST TIME

- 1 Open the email you received and tap your personal Village Voice link.
- 2 Your phone's browser will open and show the Village Voice welcome screen. Tap **Enter**.
- 3 Your name will appear. Tap **Enter Village Voice**.
- 4 You are in. The platform remembers you — next time, just open your browser and tap the link again.

SAVING THE PLATFORM TO YOUR HOME SCREEN

You can add Village Voice to your phone's home screen so it opens on its own, without going through your browser each time.

- 1 **iPhone:** In Safari, tap the Share button (the square with an arrow) and choose *Add to Home Screen*.
- 2 **Android:** In Chrome, tap the three dots menu and choose *Add to Home Screen*.



The home screen

Your starting point

The home screen shows today's date and time, a Thought for the Day, and a grid of tiles — one for each part of the platform. Tap any tile to go to that section. The bottom navigation bar gives you quick access to the most-used sections from anywhere. On every screen except the home screen, a back button sits beside the Village Voice logo at the top — tap it to retrace your steps if you prefer to navigate that way.

THE ME BUTTON

Top-left is a large green button with your silhouette and the word **Me**. This takes you to your personal space — your profile, diary, radio, and more. It belongs to you alone and is not shared with anyone.

NOTIFICATION DOTS

Some tiles show a small red number — this means there is new content since you last visited. The dot disappears once you open that section.

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

A new thought or quotation appears every day, matched to the season. Tap the card to reveal it. A gentle way to start the morning.



Me — your personal space

Just for you

The Me screen is private. Nothing here is shared with anyone else. It is your personal area for the things that matter to you.

MY PROFILE & MEDICAL CARD

Add your personal details, medical conditions, allergies, GP, and emergency contact (ICE). Your details are stored securely in your Village Voice account — not just on one device — so nothing is lost if you change phone. They are visible only to you and the Village Voice team, and are never shared with other residents. Keeping them up to date is worthwhile: ambulance crews are trained to check a person's phone for emergency and medical information.

All fields are optional. Add only what you are comfortable with.

MY DIARY

Record short voice entries for yourself. Completely private — no approval, no sharing. Useful for noting how you are feeling, recording a thought, or keeping a personal voice journal. Each entry is date-stamped and stored on your device.

MY RECORDINGS

Hold your phone near a radio or TV and tap Start Recording. Village Voice will capture up to ten minutes. You can then tap Transcribe to convert the speech to text and read it at your own pace — ideal for programmes you want to revisit, or radio content you missed first time.

SAFE ZONE

An optional feature that can alert a family member if you stray outside a defined area. This is entirely opt-in — your location is never shared without your consent, and you can stop it at any time.

MEDICATIONS

If you have medications set up, a tile will appear showing how many doses you have confirmed today. Tap it to go to your daily medication reminder — each medication is listed with a Confirm dose button. The platform records the time of each confirmation.

MY SHORTCUTS

A row of handy links the Village Voice team may add here for quick access, based on what residents find most useful. There is nothing you need to set up — anything that appears is simply there to save you a few taps.

RADIO

Tap any BBC station or Classic FM to open it in your browser. The BBC stations need a free BBC account (for BBC Sounds), and Classic FM needs a free Global Player account.

TODAY'S WIDGETS

A Joke of the Day (tap to reveal the punchline) and a Fun Fact. Both change daily.

GAMES

Quick links to Wordle, Sudoku, Solitaire, and more. Each opens in your browser. Tap Back to return to Village Voice.



Village News

Updates and notices

Village News shows announcements from the community administrators. When a new notice is posted, it appears here immediately. A red number on the News tile on the home screen tells you there is something new to read.

SEARCHING NEWS

Use the search box at the top of the News section to find a specific notice. Type a word or date and the list will filter instantly.



Events Calendar

What's on in the village

All events in the village are listed here in date order, starting from today. Bank holidays are included. Past events are automatically removed from the list.

ADDING AN EVENT TO YOUR CALENDAR

Under each event you will see two calendar buttons. Tap **Google Calendar** to add it to a Google or Android calendar. Tap **Apple / Outlook** to download a file that opens in iPhone Calendar or Microsoft Outlook.

SEARCHING EVENTS

Use the search box to find a specific event by name, venue, or type. The list filters as you type.



Message Board

Share a thought or question

The Message Board is where residents share questions, suggestions, and concerns with the whole community. Every post is checked by the community administrators before it appears, and is then shown to all residents alongside your first name and last initial.

POSTING TO THE BOARD

- 1 Tap the green + button in the top-right corner of the Message Board.
- 2 Choose a topic (Activities, Heating, Security, etc.) to help the community administrators triage your submission.
- 3 Enter a short subject and your comment. Tap **Post message**.

Please note: The board is moderated. Posts that are offensive or name individual members of staff will not be published.

LIKING A POST

Tap the heart button on any post to indicate that you agree or find it useful. The community administrators can see which posts have the most support.



Live Surveys

Have your say

Surveys are short questions posted by the community administrators on matters that affect village life. All responses are anonymous — no one can see how you voted. Results help inform decisions on behalf of residents.

ANSWERING A SURVEY

- 1 Tap your chosen option. It will be highlighted.
- 2 A confirmation box appears — check your selection and tap **Confirm my answer**. If you change your mind, tap *Choose again* first.
- 3 Results appear immediately, showing how other residents voted.

You can only vote once per survey and cannot change your answer once confirmed.



Stories — VoiceMemories

Record and listen

VoiceMemories is a living archive of life at Whiteley Village. Residents record short stories in their own voices — memories, experiences, reflections — and others can listen. Every story is transcribed automatically so it can also be read.

LISTENING TO A STORY

Tap any story card to open the player. Tap the play button on the audio bar. If a transcript is available, it appears below the player — tap **Read transcript** to read along or read instead of listening.

RECORDING YOUR OWN STORY

- 1 Tap the **+** button in the Stories section. Choose a prompt from the list or select *Record freely*.
- 2 Record a short title for your story (optional), then record the story itself. You have up to ten minutes.
- 3 Choose who can listen: just you (private), the community, your family, or publicly.
- 4 Tap **Save my story**. Community stories are reviewed before publication.

After recording, always tap **×** to close the recorder before leaving the page.

DELETING YOUR STORY

Tap your own story card and then tap **Delete my story**. Tap again to confirm. The story is removed immediately.



Community Contacts

Village staff and contacts

Community Contacts lists village staff, facilities contacts, activity leaders, and welfare support — all in one place. Tap a phone number to call. Tap an email address to open your email platform.

SEARCHING CONTACTS

Use the search box to find a specific person or team by name, role, or department.



Emergency & Contacts

Always one tap away

The Emergency section gives you instant access to 999, NHS 111, the village out-of-hours line, and all village management teams. There is also a quick-search box so you can find any contact without scrolling.

CALLING A NUMBER

Tap any phone number button. A confirmation screen appears with the name and number — tap **Confirm call** to proceed or **Cancel** to go back. This extra step prevents accidental calls.

YOUR EMERGENCY CONTACT (ICE)

If you have entered an emergency contact in your profile, it appears at the top of this section for quick access. The person named will be called in an emergency if you are unable to speak for yourself.

KEY CONTACTS AT A GLANCE

- **Emergency services** — 999
- **NHS non-emergency** — 111
- **Village main switchboard** — 01932 842360 (Mon-Fri 9am-5pm)
- **Village out of hours** — 0333 321 6349 (evenings & weekends)
- **Gas leaks — National Grid** — 0800 111 999



Documents & Handbook

The Documents section contains the Getting Started Guide (this document), the Resident Handbook, and a growing library of newsletters and community documents.

RESIDENT HANDBOOK — QUICK REFERENCE

The Handbook Quick Reference is built directly into Village Voice. Five expandable sections cover the most important information at a glance:

- **Repairs & Maintenance** — emergency, urgent and routine response times; what is and is not the village's responsibility
- **Key Rules & Policies** — visitors, vehicles, pets, alterations, anti-social behaviour
- **Health & Safety** — fire, water, damp, adverse weather, smoking, oxygen therapy
- **Village Facilities & Services** — café, shop, library, pool, transport, church, venue hire
- **Complaints & Feedback** — how to raise a complaint, the Housing Ombudsman, feedback process

Tap any section heading to expand it. All phone numbers and email addresses in the handbook are tappable.

FULL HANDBOOK PDF

A link to the full Resident Handbook PDF (v26.1) is also available at the top of the Documents section. This opens in a new tab on the official Whiteley Village website.



Clubs

Village clubs and groups

The Clubs section gives you the village clubs directory, with the clubs you belong to shown at the top of the list. Each club has its own page with news, fixtures and membership details.

Tap the Clubs tile on the home screen to open the clubs list. Some club pages are still being finalised during the trial, and editable pages for club secretaries are on the way.



Your Feedback

Shape what gets built

The amber **Your Feedback** button appears in the top-right corner of the home screen, the Me screen, and every section screen. Tap it at any time to leave a comment.

HOW TO LEAVE FEEDBACK

- 1 Tap **Your Feedback**. A panel slides in from the right.
- 2 The section you are currently on is pre-selected — you can change it using the section chips if needed.
- 3 Choose a type: **Tweak** (something could be better), **Bug** (something is broken), or **Idea** (something new).
- 4 Write your comment and tap **Submit**.

🕒 All feedback goes directly to the Village Voice team. It is reviewed regularly and directly influences what gets improved, added, or fixed. No comment is too small.



Help & Common Questions

Answers at a glance

THE PLATFORM HAS FORGOTTEN WHO I AM

This happens if your browser's history or cache has been cleared. Open your original invitation email and tap your personal link again. The platform will recognise you and restore your session.

I CAN'T HEAR THE RECORDING I MADE

If a recording shows a greyed-out audio player, the upload may still be in progress. Wait a moment and refresh the Recordings section. If the problem persists, the recording may have been saved locally only — tap the microphone to record again.

THE PLATFORM LOOKS WRONG OR OUTDATED

Village Voice updates automatically. If something looks wrong, try pulling down to refresh the page in your browser. If the issue persists, sign out using the Sign Out button and sign back in via your personal link.

I HAVE A QUESTION THAT IS NOT HERE

Use the **Your Feedback** button to send a message, or contact the Village Voice team directly at colinhills@voicevillage.co.uk.

SIGNING OUT

Tap **Sign out** in the top-right corner of the home screen or sections screen. Your personal link will still work to sign back in. Signing out clears your session from the browser — useful if you share a device.